



Guidelines

EYE SURGERY

EYE & EYELID SURGERY

(Cataract, Pterygium, Strabismus, Trabeculectomy, Vitrectomy, Blepharoplasty, Ectropian/Entropion)

Scope

Site	Service/Department/Unit	Disciplines
OPH	Surgical Ward	All Surgical Ward Staff

Procedure

LEGISLATIVE REQUIREMENTS

Informed, written patient consent needs to be obtained prior to the patient having pre-operative sedation or being anaesthetised.

MEDICAL REQUIREMENTS

Investigation results are available if required.

SAFETY INFORMATION

Check the Operation Record for specific surgeon's instructions and the Anaesthetic Record for instructions from the anaesthetist.

Ensure you are aware of the operative procedure requirements.

- **If appropriate inform Doctor if pupil not dilating after eye drops have been instilled.**

This standard should be read in conjunction with the Practice Guideline:

- Pre-operative Care
- Post-operative Care
- Falls Prevention and Management
- Eye Treatments

Hospital Policy

- Patient Intra-Hospital Transfers

NURSING MANAGEMENT

PRE-OPERATIVELY

- Elective admission documentation is to be completed prior to surgery by ward nurse.
- Baseline observations are recorded as per Pre-operative care in the N&MPG.
- Pre-operative eye drops are administered as ordered by the surgeon
- Pre-medication is administered if ordered.
- The patient has obtained post-op eye drops or (is aware they must obtain their eye drops from a Chemist when they receive their prescription).
- Note on Perioperative checklist if written prescription required for post op eye drop administration. (NB All nursing home patient and patients having their eye drops instilled by contracted providers e.g. Silver Chain require a prescription)
- Educate patient regarding pain score 0 -10.
- Ensure Venous Thrombo Embolism (VTE) assessment is completed (for general anaesthetic patients only).
- All patients having a general anaesthetic are to wear anti-embolic stockings to theatre
- (Falls Risk Assessment) is completed for all patients.

POST-OPERATIVELY

Observations:

- Routine observations are recorded as per Post operative care in the N&MPG
- Eye Pad and/or shield insitu on return to ward. Remove as per the surgeon's specific orders
- Check surgical site and record any abnormalities on the designated section of the Observation Chart.

Pain Management:

- Administer analgesics as prescribed/required

Nutrition and Hydration:

- For GA patients - IV fluids are maintained until free oral fluids are tolerated.
- Diet is resumed as tolerated.
- Increased fibre may be needed.
- LA patients must tolerate fluids or diet prior to discharge

Discharge Process:

- Patient is discharged when they meet discharge criteria as per Discharge Criteria for Day Patients NPG.
- If any concerns post-discharge to contact their surgeon.
- In an Emergency, patient to attend nearest Emergency Department with operation record.
- Patient to be given procedure specific discharge information.
- Return all medications and x-rays as appropriate.
- Ensure patient aware of follow-up appointment as indicated on operation report

Medications:

- To commence prescribed eye drops as ordered by the surgeon on the operation report
- Regular medications to be continued.
- For Post Op patients needing Diamox: Pharmacy will supply bottles of Diamox Please ensure you fill out the label and attach a patient MRN label to the bottle as well.
- Nursing Home patients and those patients having eye drops instilled by a contracted provider require post operative eye drops prescribed on the National Inpatient Medication Chart or recognised medication chart for eye drops to be instilled.

Health Education:

- How to care for their operated eye as per Discharge Information sheet.
- To wear glasses during the day and eye shield at night for the first week.
Eye shield to be worn at night as per the surgeon's specific instructions.

Related Documents / References

Authorisation & Version Control

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Acknowledgments:	J Connolly, Area Manager Surgical Ward; Dr V Raja, Ophthalmology Consultant				

For full details regarding, development, review, consultation, approval, endorsement - contact the Policy Officer for the submission form

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